

## FILM REVIEW



SLUMDOG MILLIONAIRE

## Maximum MOVIE

RATING ★ ★ ★ ★ ☆

**Director:** Danny Boyle**Starring:** Dev Patel, Freida Pinto, Anil Kapoor

A slumdog goes on a game show with a Rs 2-crore prize. Not to win it

but to reach the woman he has been looking for all his life. Love! The bad brother dies while allowing the good brother to claim the woman. Sacrifice! Boy meets girl, despite being separated by a running train. Destiny! Vikas Swarup's novel *Q & A* has been translated into a brilliant screenplay that borrows liberally from Salim-Javed potboilers. It's a dazzling ride into Mumbai's in-

nards, shot on the run by *The Last King of Scotland*'s Anthony Dod Mantle, with Indian actors, a largely Indian crew, and a full-on Indian story. This is the story that Bollywood ought to have made for the city that hosts it. But does it matter who made it? Jamal and Latika's epic love story, told through the horrific Mumbai riots, a detour with some silly Americans in the Taj Mahal, a gangland boss straight out of *Company*, a classic fraternal confrontation in an unfinished skyscraper overlooking the shanties which could have been in *Deewar*, and hey even a dance with a kickass chorus to an anthem sung by Sukhvinder Singh. *Jai Ho*. This is Bollywood Unlimited, through the sharp eye of an outsider who thinks with his heart, not mind. A hybrid director for a masala film in these chutneyfied times. **by Kaveree Bamzai**

## FILM REVIEW

CHANDNI CHOWK TO CHINA

## Chinese TORTURE

RATING ★ ★ ☆ ☆ ☆

**Director:** Nikhil Advani**Starring:** Akshay Kumar, Deepika Padukone, Ranbir Shorey

What has a smart beginning, energetic end and stretches like the Great Wall of China in between? Yes, *Chandni Chowk to China*. Akshay Kumar's attempt to cross over to the West like Jackie Chan and Jet Li remains the shortest long jump in history, as he tries to give us yet an-

other Happy Singh clone, a loveable idiot Sidhu who clutches his groin, rubs his butt and talks to a potato for inspiration. It doesn't work. Kumar gets far too serious midway in a madcap movie, starts to deliver lectures on the hard working home-makers of India, gets urinated and

spat upon, and weeps copiously as his adoptive father dies to an appropriate Karan Johar-inspired chorus on the soundtrack. There's too much of Deepika Padukone, who plays twins, and lets her legs walk away with the movie. What could have been a smart synthesis of two of the greatest movie producing cultures today, Hong Kong and India, ends up being just another brick in the wall. The rude jokes about the Chinese amuse somewhat, the cosmic kung fu is good, if intermittent, and Gordon Liu almost saves the day with his deadly bowler. But then Akshay insists on exercising his tear ducts. *Naan ke saath* noodle may be fun and maybe Feng Shashtra too but Akshay as kung fu warrior isn't. Forget the dude, give me the tuber anyway. **-KB**

